

New JETRO Regional and Analysis Report Notice (July 30, 2026 Issue)

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Thank you for using JETRO Members Service.

We are pleased to deliver information about new regional and analysis reports on the political and economic trends of major countries and regions worldwide, prepared by JETRO from its unique perspective. We hope you will find them useful.

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[Special Feature] Universities Producing Highly Skilled Foreign Talent - Frontline Insights
<Additional Article>

Japan's talent recruitment market has remained a seller's market in recent years. The shortage of science and engineering professionals is particularly acute, with companies increasingly turning their attention to foreign talent. Meanwhile, approximately 70% of domestic international students are majoring in humanities, resulting in fewer science and engineering professionals. Against this backdrop, interest is growing in international students studying science and engineering in English and science and engineering professionals enrolled in overseas universities. Additionally, more companies are seeking to hire students studying Japanese at overseas universities regardless of their major. This special feature, based on interviews with promising domestic and international universities producing science and engineering professionals and Japanese language learners interested in employment in Japan, introduces characteristic curricula, employment status at Japanese companies, and messages for companies.

<Additional Article>

■Laos

◇Current State and Potential of Highly Skilled Human Resource Development (2):
Pathways for Laotian University Graduates to Skilled Worker Status

[Special Feature] Business Cases in Africa <Additional Article>
Company Interviews and Activities Surrounding TICAD9

As attention grows on economic cooperation between Japan and Africa, the 9th Tokyo International Conference on African Development (TICAD9) was held in Yokohama in August 2025. African business opportunities are not limited to large corporations with networks and capital, but are also expected to benefit small and medium enterprises across various sectors. In Africa, diverse approaches are possible for each country, including partnerships with third-country companies such as European firms with proven track records and local enterprises. This special feature broadly introduces business cases of Japanese companies and local enterprises in Africa.

<Additional Article>

■ Japanese Company Case Studies - Japanese Companies' African Business

◇ Dots for: Addressing the Digital Divide in West Africa

[Special Feature] Middle East in Turmoil: Impact on Middle Eastern Countries and Outlook

<Additional Article>

Following the destabilization of Middle East conditions, the business environment surrounding companies operating in the region has changed dramatically. This special feature examines the Middle East and North Africa (MENA) region, tracking recent trends in logistics, trade, and various industries, as well as corporate initiatives. Through investigation and analysis of government responses and economic policies in response to current conditions, we clarify geopolitical risks and new market opportunities in the MENA region from multiple perspectives, introducing a wide range of information to support Japanese companies' future Middle East business activities.

<Additional Articles>

◇ Impact of Deteriorating Middle East Conditions on International Aviation Networks (1): Air Passenger Transport

◇ Middle East Automotive Trends (1): China Takes the Lead; Japan Achieves Record Exports

◇ Middle East Automotive Trends (2): Strait of Hormuz Closure Affects Japanese Automobile Exports

[United States]

Democratic Party Strategy and Challenges to Counter Trump Supporters Ahead of U.S. Midterm Elections

Both chambers of the current U.S. federal Congress see Republican dominance, but seats are closely divided between Democrats and Republicans. The November 2026 midterm elections will determine which party gains majority control of each chamber. The election results will influence the management of the second half of the second Trump administration. While declining approval ratings for President Donald Trump are viewed as favorable for Democrats, the party faces challenges including internal reform and selecting new leadership ahead of the 2028 presidential election.

[Asia-Cambodia]

Cambodia Undertakes Serious Consideration of First Unified Commercial Code

The Cambodian government is working to systematically organize business-related laws and compile them as a unified commercial code. The effort aims to facilitate business activities, improve the investment environment, and enhance legal system consistency. In June 2026, the government held its first public seminar on this initiative. This article examines the background and necessity of the unified commercial code through comparison with legal systems in major ASEAN countries, and explores its necessity, institutional design issues, and impact on Japanese companies through an interview with

Kazuo Sakano, an advisor to the Cambodian Ministry of Justice who has been involved in legal system support.

[Asia-India]

India's Fierce Monsoon: Analysis of Impact on Macroeconomic Conditions

India's monsoon is not merely a seasonal weather phenomenon but an important environmental factor significantly affecting the country's overall economic activity. The majority of annual precipitation comes from the southwest monsoon rains that arrive from June to September, with the agricultural sector particularly dependent on this rainfall. Monsoon intensity influences not only crop yields but also consumer activity. Furthermore, through food prices and inflation rates...